

Sennheiser CEO discusses pro audio evolution and India's role in it

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At a time when the audio industry worldwide, and particularly in India, is experiencing transformative changes, spurred by technological advancements and shifts in consumer behaviour, we spoke with Dr Andreas Sennheiser, CEO of the renowned audio company Sennheiser, in a chat on the audio company's vision and strategies for the vibrant Indian market.

Sennheiser revealed insights into everything from how AI is impacting audio technology to the future of audio entertainment, and much more. Edited excerpts of our interview follow:

Q What has been your impression of the pro audio market in India?

A Since the pandemic, we've seen a lot of change when it comes to adopting new technology and also new ways of working, particularly hybrid work. Producing content for hybrid consumption has advanced greatly. The pandemic was a catalyst for a lot of new formats that

we see right now in the corporate, higher education world, and also in the broadcast world. Particularly when it comes to higher education, we see most universities really ramping up their technology when it comes to audio streaming so that students can participate from home or in the classroom. And most corporations have fully embraced the idea of hybrid work or even work from home. Even the broadcast world brought us some new hybrid work formats.

Q Sennheiser's India and APAC direction?

A Our focus on the pro audio world is really to make sure that we're even closer to our end users and understand their workflows better than before. It will help us bring out products that just make it easier for customers to use, as we use more and more complex technology but want to make sure that the customer sees less of it. So there's greater emphasis in making seamless integration of user interfaces across all our products, like the ceiling microphones integrate very well with just the normal standard mics, for instance.

We are focused on enhancing the user experience, and in order to do that we have to research and develop the technology while understanding the workflow of our users more intimately. That's where we're putting all our management attention, all our R&D efforts and all our resources into the pro audio field.

Q India's role in Sennheiser's global product development roadmap?

A Yeah, India has a very strong role when it comes to identifying new ways of working. That was very eminent already when I was here before the pandemic as well. OB van crews were becoming few and far in between, as use of mobile devices for live TV broadcast started growing. Absence of a great infrastructure led to very innovative solutions among tech adopters in India. And that's why, for me, still today when it comes to adopting new technology, India is really on the forefront.

It's almost like a test bed of new technologies and new work formats in the audio field. And in order to do that, of course we have our development